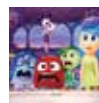


**\$2.5M worth books stolen**

Thieves snuck into a warehouse and stole \$2.5 million worth of rare books by Newton, Da Vinci, Dante, and others. <http://dgit.in/Bkthieve>

**Free storytelling lessons**

Disney-owned animation studio, Pixar, is offering free online lessons in storytelling via Khan Academy. <http://dgit.in/KhanPixar>

SHOOTOUT: BEST SMARTPHONES BETWEEN ₹10-20K

PICKING THE MID-RANGED WONDER



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First things first, over the past year or so, more and more smartphone OEMs in India have been talking about the experience a smartphone provides. The reason is simple — the specs war had an expiry date and we're almost there. In our humble opinion, choosing a smartphone based on experience is always a better idea than going for raw specifications, even though specifications do matter to some extent on an Android phone.

With that said, this month's comparison considers 15 smartphones in the 10-20k price range. The sheer variation in specifications would tell you that we're trying to objectively judge the phones for the overall experience that they provide. We will be picking a best performer, best buy and the editor's pick.

We have even included phones like the Xiaomi Mi Max and Lenovo Phab 2 Plus, that would ideally appeal only to a niche audience. However, the comparison should give you a wholesome idea of what to buy irrespec-

tive of what your choices are. Remember, though, our picks are based on phones that provide the best experience and performance overall.

PERFORMANCE

The term performance is generally associated with the processor and the raw power that a phone provides. As explained above, while our test sheets and formulae do combine other aspects into this section, for the sake of convenience, we're going to start discussing the speed of these devices, before we get to the camera and battery life.

With Qualcomm's Snapdragon 650 SoC, smartphones in the sub-15k and sub-20k price brackets had taken an incredible turn. But, that was all good till Lenovo went and screwed things up for everyone else. The company is currently selling a Snapdragon 820-powered phone for as low as ₹14,999. Use as many 14nm chipsets as you will, or Cortex A72 clusters, you're not beating a flagship-class so easily.

And that's exactly what has happened here. The Lenovo Z2 Plus edges past everything else in terms of